

John Escobedo

Customer Service Specialist | De-escalation & Account Recovery | Trilingual (English/Spanish/ASL)

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(512) 299-3269

Austin, Texas

Summary: Customer service professional with 20+ years delivering empathetic, high-touch support across gaming, healthcare, government, and live event environments. Career anchored by frontline support roles at Blizzard Entertainment and Linden Lab, where I de-escalated emotionally charged user conflicts, restored compromised accounts, and resolved complex issues through patient listening and clear communication. That service mindset carried into UAT leadership, stakeholder advocacy, and user research across VA healthcare, Deaf accessibility, and HIPAA-regulated platforms, championing end-user needs so shipped products genuinely serve the people they're built for. Trilingual communicator (English, Spanish, ASL) with proven ability to build rapport with diverse audiences in person, by phone, via live chat, and through ticket systems.

Skills

Problem-Solving & Analysis: Attention to Detail, Analytical Thinking, Problem-Solving, Critical Thinking

Interpersonal & Collaboration: Clear Communication, Curiosity, Cross-functional Collaboration, Mentoring

Customer Service & Support: High-Touch Customer Support, De-escalation & Conflict Resolution, Account Recovery & Restoration, Live Chat Support

Accessibility & Inclusive Design: 508 Compliance Testing, WCAG Awareness, JAWS Screen Reader, NVDA Screen Reader

Industry Expertise: Healthcare & Telehealth, Gaming & Entertainment, Educational Technology, Live Events & Hosting

Office and Image Suites: Adobe Creative Suite, Office 365: Teams, Word, Excel, PowerPoint, Outlook, Google Workspace: Drive, Docs, Sheets, Canva

Professional Experience

Software Tester (Volunteer)

Sharpee.net | Austin, TX (Remote)

March 2026 to Present

Performing end-to-end exploratory and feature-level testing of new web-based software, contributing test infrastructure and documentation improvements directly to the codebase, and producing standardized failure reports that accelerate developer triage.

- Conducting end-to-end, feature-oriented exploratory testing across browsers and platforms, validating complete user workflows rather than isolated component behavior.
- Identifying critical silent-failure defects, including a case where the application returned blank responses with no error signaling, a class of bug that scripted suites pass without detection and requires exploratory observation to surface.
- Authoring a custom output template for the project's bespoke in-house test system, standardizing failure reports so any reader, regardless of QA background, can immediately see what failed and why.
- Leading maintenance of a 17-step user tutorial, cascading consistent updates across all steps whenever foundational changes occur to keep documentation aligned with current product behavior.
- Working directly in the project codebase via a Git pull-request workflow, reading source to inform test scenarios and submitting improvements back rather than only filing tickets.

Karaoke Host

Freelance | Austin, TX

July 2025 to Present

Hosted live karaoke events, managing audience engagement, real-time decision-making, and technical operations to create memorable experiences for diverse audiences.

- Coordinated event flow and timing while adapting to audience needs and requests in real-time.

- Managed technical setup including sound systems, software, and troubleshooting to ensure seamless delivery.
- Created inclusive, welcoming atmosphere that encouraged participation from guests of all skill levels.
- Balanced competing priorities (song queue, timing, audience energy) to optimize overall experience.

Robot Tele-Operator

Appttronik (via Insight Global) | Austin, TX

July 2025 to September 2025

Served as communication bridge between operations and engineering for Appttronik's humanoid robot development, translating observed behaviors into actionable documentation and establishing process standards in a fast-paced, ambiguous environment.

- Translated observed robot behaviors into clear, actionable bug reports that accelerated issue resolution for engineering teams.
- Authored startup, shutdown, and emergency shutdown procedures for 2 robot models where none existed, reducing new tester ramp-up time by approximately 50% and establishing reference materials adopted as team standard.
- Bridged operations and engineering communication, keeping both teams aligned on priorities and findings.
- Reached full productivity in a novel role with minimal onboarding, independently navigating a complex robotics domain.
- Reduced physical testing environment setup time by 75% by standardizing the preparation pattern, ensuring consistent and repeatable conditions for data collection.

Senior QA Test Lead | Quality Assurance Tester | Scrum Master

GeekSI | Tallahassee, FL

March 2019 to June 2025

Senior contractor providing requirements analysis, UAT leadership, and quality assurance across multiple mission-critical VA healthcare projects. Subject matter expert for complex clinical modules, facilitating knowledge transfer and driving process standardization across distributed teams.

- Became the go-to SME for the Traumatic Brain Injury module, running knowledge transfer sessions that enabled cross-functional teams to navigate complex healthcare domain requirements.
- Championed the transition from Waterfall to Agile, introducing release discipline and predictable delivery cycles to teams accustomed to ad-hoc shipping practices.
- Advocated for and implemented code freeze and release candidate practices, shifting teams from reactive firefighting to proactive quality control.
- Used JIRA and Confluence daily to manage test cases, track defects, document requirements, and coordinate with distributed teams across multiple VA projects.
- Performed SOAP API testing for VA home loan processing systems, populating and validating service queries to ensure data integrity across .NET-based applications.
- Conducted REST API testing using Postman to verify backend services and data contracts for Java-based healthcare modules.
- Executed manual test strategies across .NET and Java platforms including functional, regression, integration, and end-to-end testing for clinical healthcare applications.
- Developed and maintained comprehensive test strategies encompassing UAT, regression, smoke, sanity, and 508 compliance testing for VA healthcare systems.
- Drove standardization of testing practices and documentation across multiple VA projects, building consensus among distributed teams and reducing onboarding time for new analysts.
- Advocated for accessibility as a core quality metric, leading 508 compliance initiatives and educating team members on inclusive design requirements.
- Performed hands-on screen reader validation with JAWS and NVDA on VA clinical interfaces, surfacing accessibility issues not catchable through visual inspection alone.
- Collaborated with automation engineers to validate Cucumber/Selenium scripts, catching requirement-execution gaps before automated tests went into rotation.

- Built requirements traceability documentation that mapped every business need to test coverage across web, mainframe, and mobile platforms.
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DJ

Freelance | Austin, TX

January 2011 to April 2012

DJed at various dances and events around Austin, TX, coordinating with venues and adapting to diverse audience needs.

- Created DJ setlists for Danceversity, Dance International, and Synergy Dance Studio based on event requirements and audience preferences.
 - Adapted to various in-house sound systems and venue constraints.
 - Coordinated with event organizers to align music selection with event tone and timing.
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Senior QA Test Lead | Quality Assurance Tester

EverlyWell | Austin, TX

June 2018 to October 2018

Partnered with engineering and product leadership to establish quality processes and design cross-team workflows for a health tech startup's secure patient portal during a period of rapid organizational change.

- Served as JIRA administrator, designing a unified JIRA workflow with custom issue types, screens, and transitions that facilitated smoother cross-team collaboration and visibility into release status.
 - Managed JIRA project configurations including permission schemes, notification settings, and dashboard creation to support QA and development workflows.
 - Assessed release risks and communicated go/no-go recommendations to product and engineering leadership, balancing speed-to-market with quality.
 - Defined initial QA process and release validation criteria for a team shipping without formal quality gates, establishing standards that brought predictability to a fast-moving startup environment.
 - Mentored team members on effective documentation practices and quality standards to foster a culture of quality across the organization.
 - Validated releases across all major browsers and mobile devices, catching requirement gaps before production deployment.
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QA Test Lead | QA Analyst

YouScience | Austin, TX

July 2017 to June 2018

As the sole QA resource, built comprehensive quality processes and test infrastructure for the company's flagship education assessment platform, earning credibility with development and product teams.

- Introduced foundational quality practices—version control discipline, release candidates, and structured validation—to a team shipping without formal QA process, establishing credibility that integrated quality as a respected part of the SDLC.
 - Created end-to-end test documentation spanning procedures, requirements traceability, and verification standards.
 - Improved developer-QA communication by introducing standardized user story and acceptance criteria templates, reducing ambiguity and accelerating delivery.
 - Created and maintained product documentation to support new feature releases and ensure consistent understanding of requirements.
 - Owned end-to-end validation for the flagship web application, gating every release across browsers and mobile platforms.
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QA Tester | QA Analyst

Luna Data Solutions | Austin, TX

May 2015 to May 2017

Contracted as QA Analyst for RetailMeNot, coordinating cross-team efforts for high-visibility e-commerce feature launches and aligning testing priorities with business objectives.

- Coordinated QA efforts across multiple teams for the gift card feature launch supporting a \$22M acquisition, aligning testing priorities with business objectives and leadership expectations.
- Built custom JavaScript tools to validate site-wide analytics implementation and data integrity, ensuring business requirements were accurately captured.
- Created standardized test documentation and data suites that eliminated inconsistencies across testing environments.
- Responded to live production issues under pressure, triaging problems and communicating status updates to leadership during critical outages.
- Partnered with developers to enhance internal tooling, ensure a CI/CD workflow, and contribute improvements that increased team efficiency.

QA Test Lead | QA Analyst

Communication Services for the Deaf | Austin, TX

May 2013 to January 2015

Developed inaugural QA process for an accessibility-focused video interpreting platform, immersing in user community to ensure product truly met the needs of Deaf and hard-of-hearing users.

- Invested in learning American Sign Language and Deaf cultural norms to understand user needs and ensure the product truly served its community—a user research approach that informed requirements validation.
- Established the company's first-ever quality assurance function from zero, defining test procedures and quality benchmarks that enabled the team to identify non-functional code blocking product delivery.
- Managed full validation lifecycle including creating test plans, executing test runs, and reporting results to stakeholders for both web and mobile platforms.
- Solved cross-platform testing limitations by implementing a VirtualBox-based solution, expanding test coverage to previously unreachable environments.

Lead QA Tester | Quality Assurance Tester

DocbookMD | Austin, TX

July 2012 to April 2013

Founded and scaled the QA function for a HIPAA-compliant healthcare messaging app, ensuring regulatory requirements were met while building the team and processes where none existed.

- Analyzed and documented HIPAA compliance requirements, ensuring application met strict regulatory standards for secure transmission of patient health information.
- Grew the QA department from a solo operation to a full team, hiring, onboarding, and mentoring new analysts while codifying repeatable quality processes.
- Developed initial test strategy and comprehensive documentation to ensure software met business and regulatory requirements before release.
- Executed functional, regression, and HIPAA compliance validation across all supported mobile devices, including devising creative testing methods (simulating network outages via elevator rides) to catch edge cases missed by standard approaches.

Event Coordinator and Host

Kick Butt Coffee | Austin, TX

January 2011 to April 2012

Organized and coordinated weekly dance events, managing vendors, technical setup, and community engagement.

- Organized and ran weekly events, coordinating DJs, venue logistics, and audience engagement.
- Set up technical infrastructure to allow seamless integration with house audio systems.
- Managed event promotion and community communication through social media.

Game Master | Customer Experience & Trust Specialist

Blizzard Entertainment | Austin, TX
July 2010 to July 2011

- Provided empathetic, high-touch customer experience support for World of Warcraft, analyzing complex issues and documenting findings for development teams while maintaining user trust in high-volume environment.
- Analyzed and documented cases of fraud and exploitation, providing detailed reports with root cause analysis for development teams.
 - Provided compassionate support during emotionally charged escalations, restoring lost items and accounts while maintaining user trust.
 - De-escalated frustrated users through patient listening and clear communication, turning negative experiences into moments of trust.
 - Delivered high-volume support via live chat and ticket systems, balancing efficiency with genuine care for each user's experience.
 - Restored compromised accounts with precision, adhering to strict security and data integrity protocols.

QA Analyst | Support Tools Developer | Community Operations

Linden Lab | San Francisco, CA (Remote)
March 2007 to June 2010

- Progressed through three promotions from frontline support to QA Analyst, identifying operational inefficiencies and building solutions while establishing customer support processes.
- Identified operational inefficiencies and took initiative to build custom diagnostic tools, demonstrating gap analysis and solution design capabilities.
 - Played key role in establishing customer support processes and documentation using Parature ticket system and live chat.
 - Promoted to QA Analyst after demonstrating exceptional analytical and diagnostic skills; responsible for testing daily builds and documenting complex issues.
 - Served as frontline First Responder, managing in-world emergencies, enforcing Terms of Service, and resolving user conflicts.
 - Earned three promotions in three years through consistent performance, initiative, and demonstrated ability to take on increasing responsibility.

Additional Experience

Executive Assistant	LOC Consultants	(2005-2006)
Receptionist	GoDance Studios	(2005-2005)
Building Monitor	UT Performing Arts Center	(2004-2004)
Digital Artist / Webmaster	Computer Discovery Center	(2002-2004)
Minister / Web Master	Weddings Performed	(2002-2003)

Education

Austin Community College
American Sign Language
2015 - 2017

ASL School
American Sign Language
2008 - 2012

Vista College - Berkeley, CA
Video Editing and Life Drawing
2001 - 2002

A.I. of Houston - Houston, TX

Fine Art, Typography, Layout, 3D Max
1995 - 1996

San Jacinto College - Pasadena, TX

Computer Science, Fine Art
1993 - 1995

Online version: <https://johnesco.github.io/resume>